

2.4 Protecting your profile on social networking sites

Social networking sites are the hottest places to meet people online nowadays. Interest groups, blogs, chatting, hobbies, friends, business networking – these sites mimic all the aspects of real life socialising but online. Just like real life, however, you're open to attacks and theft of information online. When setting up a profile on a social networking site like Facebook or Myspace, it's essential to determine what info you wish to post. Your name, age, gender, zip code and email address are usually required to create an account. The info that should never be shared on your profile include: Address, phone number, social security number and credit card number.

It's not just about the info you share but who you want to share it with. When you first join a social networking site, the default setting is to allow anyone to see your profile and updates. Sites such as Facebook go even further: Your activities will not only be shared with various friends and groups, but also across every single network you've ever traversed. You can disable these settings in the account settings and unchecking "Allow anyone to see my public search listing" along with restricting your email IDs, IM names and other details to people on your friends list.

It's vital to understand the privacy policy of some of

Facebook Pages

Facebook Pages are special profiles used solely for commercial, political, or charitable purposes. You may not set up a Facebook Page on behalf of another individual or entity unless you are authorized to do so. This includes fan Facebook Pages, as well as Facebook Pages to support or criticize another individual or entity.

FACEBOOK DOES NOT PRE-SCREEN OR APPROVE FACEBOOK PAGES, AND CANNOT GUARANTEE THAT A FACEBOOK PAGE WAS ACTUALLY CREATED AND IS BEING OPERATED BY THE INDIVIDUAL OR ENTITY THAT IS THE SUBJECT OF A FACEBOOK PAGE. NOR IS FACEBOOK RESPONSIBLE FOR THE CONTENT OF ANY FACEBOOK PAGE, OR ANY TRANSACTIONS ENTERED INTO OR OTHER ACTIONS TAKEN ON OR IN CONNECTION WITH ANY FACEBOOK PAGE, INCLUDING HOW THE OWNER OF THE FACEBOOK PAGE COLLECTS, HANDLES, USES AND / OR SHARES ANY PERSONAL INFORMATION IT MAY COLLECT FROM USERS (PLEASE REVIEW THE FACEBOOK PRIVACY POLICY IF YOU HAVE ANY QUESTIONS OR CONCERNS REGARDING THE USE OR SHARING OF YOUR PERSONAL INFORMATION). YOU SHOULD BE CAREFUL BEFORE PROVIDING ANY PERSONAL INFORMATION TO OR ENTERING INTO ANY TRANSACTION IN CONNECTION WITH A FACEBOOK PAGE.

In addition to these Terms of Use, Facebook Pages are subject to and governed by certain Additional Terms Applicable to Facebook Pages. The Additional Terms Applicable to Facebook Pages control in the event of any conflict between them and the Terms of Use.

Carefully read the privacy policy of the web sites that gather your personal information